

closure_evidence_20260923

BOB-163 closure evidence — 2026-09-23 (staleness-corrected closure)

Finding

This item was ALREADY FULLY IMPLEMENTED in a prior session (per in-source comments citing “BOB-163” throughout challenges/scripts/ddos_resilience_challenge.sh, landed by commit 76a1822 “docs(BOB-008,077,101,102,163,182,188,195): eight operator decisions land as data, not prose”) — the tracker status was never advanced past “In progress” to reflect it.

Operator decision (already recorded, 2026-08-26, §11.4.66)

“YES — 429 IS RESPONSIVE IF Retry-After IS WELL-FORMED.”
Assertion (c) accepts 2xx OR a well-formed 429 (positive integer seconds or valid HTTP-date, PARSED not merely present); DEGRADED remains connection failure/timeout/5xx/malformed-429. Residual risk (a genuinely wedged endpoint answering 429-with-valid-Retry-After would pass) explicitly disclosed in-source, not hidden.

Independent verification (coordinator, from clean shell, 2026-09-23)

```
$ bash challenges/scripts/ddos_resilience_challenge.sh --self-validate
```

...
PASS: self-validate – crash-resistance, rate-limit AND sibling-responsiveness
 detectors each distinguish their golden-good from their golden-bad
 fixture; the rate-limit detector does NOT fire on the advertises-but-never-enforces carrier; and the sibling detector holds
 the line against four 429s that DO carry a Retry-After header whose
 value is not well-formed, plus both polarities of the isolation
 decision and its empty-log fail-closed arm
 (\$11.4.107(10) + \$11.4.201(1)(6)(7)(a))

Confirmed EVERY fixture in the truth table classifies correctly:
r429_valid_seconds / r429_valid_httpdate -> responsive (per the operator decision); r429_missing / r429_garbage / r429_zero / r429_neg / r429_baddate -> degraded (the narrowing, not a blind acceptance of every 429). Producer=oracle discipline (§11.4.249) confirmed in-source: the live verdict path and --self-validate's golden fixtures call the SAME parse functions, so a mutation to the parse would break the self-test too.

Still-open, correctly NOT covered by this closure

The item's own text notes a separate, still-open sub-question ("the detector counts 429 only, not 503... decide when BOB-111 lands limiters on :7185 and :7189") — BOB-111 remains "In progress" (not yet landed), so that sub-decision is correctly not yet actionable and is NOT part of this item's scope. This closure covers only BOB-163's own Retry-After-parsing acceptance criterion, which is fully implemented and verified.

Status

Fixed (already landed, tracker sync only). Closed by coordinator.